Digital Literacy Report

CSE0001: Digital Literacy

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Introduction:

In the rapidly evolving landscape of the 21st century, digital literacy has transformed from a supplementary skill into an undeniable important one for academic and professional excellence. This portfolio documents my journey as a Student Digital Ambassador, a role dedicated to promote safe, effective, and responsible technology use among my peers. Throughout this project, I have immersed myself in the multifaceted world of digital citizenship, from mastering collaborative tools like GitHub and Google Workspace to developing an informed understanding of cybersecurity and professional etiquette. Each task provided an opportunity to sharpen my technical capabilities and craft resources that empower others to navigate the digital world with confidence. This report captures the real-world application of these competencies, illustrating how digital literacy equips students to communicate with impact and safeguard their professional identity in an increasingly interconnected global environment.

Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness Resource

Digital Tool Used: Canva

Selected Topics: Defining Digital Literacy (Locate, Evaluate, Share), Essential Student Tools, Professional Etiquette (Do's and Don'ts), and Cybersecurity Best Practices.

Reflection: As a Student Digital Ambassador, I designed an original infographic "A Guide to Digital Success" as a visually compelling roadmap tailored for students at VIT Bhopal. My goal was to distill digital literacy into four powerful, actionable modules for immediate real-world application.

I established core competencies; Locate, Evaluate, and Share, emphasizing source verification in an era of rampant misinformation, while spotlighting essential platforms: GitHub, HackerRank, Google Workspace, and Canva. A crisp "Do's and Don'ts" checklist helped peers build a professional online reputation, complemented by a "Safe Internet Practices" section covering Multi-Factor Authentication and UPI security.

Using Canva, I created a clear visual hierarchy that made complex information scannable and engaging. This task reaffirmed that true digital literacy is the powerful intersection of technical proficiency, ethical communication, and vigilant cybersecurity, and I am proud to have built a resource that guides students through both academic and professional digital environments.

Task 2: Professional Portfolio Development

Platforms used: LinkedIn, GitHub, and Kaggle.

Reflection: Building a strong professional identity is at the heart of digital literacy. In this task, I curated my online presence across four key platforms to align with my role as a Student Digital Ambassador.

I revamped my LinkedIn profile to create a networking-ready digital footprint representing my journey at VIT Bhopal. On GitHub, I activated the special README profile feature, a personalized landing page showcasing my passion for CSE-AIML and my skills in Python and C++. I also launched a Kaggle profile to demonstrate my commitment to data science.

By synchronizing these platforms, I have proudly evolved from a passive technology consumer to an active, professional contributor. This deliberate approach to Digital Branding ensures my online identity remains consistent, high-quality, and growth-oriented, telling a clear story of my technical development and collaborative mindset.

Task 3: Productivity and Collaborative Tools

Part A: Digital Problem Solving and Technical Proficiency

Platforms used: HackerEarth

Technical Skills: Python

Reflections: Technical problem-solving is a core pillar of digital literacy. In Part A, I applied my programming skills to a computational challenge on HackerEarth, a platform designed to test logical thinking and code efficiency. Successfully completing this task demonstrated my ability to navigate technical ecosystems used for skill validation in the tech industry. This exercise reinforced that digital literacy extends beyond using software; it involves crafting logical solutions to complex problems. Ultimately, it boosted my confidence in using competitive platforms to showcase my technical growth as a CSE-AIML student, preparing me for continuous professional learning.

Part B: Collaborative Tools and Data Collection

Platforms used: Google Forms, Google Sheets

Reflections: As a Student Digital Ambassador, I created a "Digital Literacy & Tech Awareness Survey" using Google Forms to assess the digital habits and cybersecurity awareness of my peers at VIT Bhopal. By combining multiple-choice and short-answer questions, I ensured the survey was both engaging and insightful. I also integrated Google Sheets for real-time response tracking, showcasing the power of Google Workspace in automating workflows and organizing data efficiently. This task reinforced a key professional skill — using digital tools to transform raw inputs into structured, actionable information. It was a truly enriching experience!

Task 4: The Case Study for using Social-Media Properly

Situation: The Misinterpreted GitHub Comment

We've all been there: you spend hours on a project, only to get a blunt message like, "This is wrong; fix it." Without seeing a friendly face or hearing a helpful tone, those few words can feel like a personal attack instead of just a correction. Suddenly, you aren't just thinking about the work; you're wondering if you're even good at what you do. This one cold comment can quickly ruin the team's mood, making everyone afraid to speak up or ask questions. In the end, the whole project slows down because a simple piece of feedback was missing the human touch that makes collaboration work.

What could have been done differently?

The fix is actually quite simple: treat the person behind the screen with the same respect you would in person. Instead of a cold correction, the lead could have said, "I noticed a potential issue with the logic here—could we jump on a quick call to look at another way to do this?" By using "I" statements and offering to help rather than just pointing out a mistake, the feedback stays helpful instead of hurtful. This small change in tone keeps the project moving and makes the whole team feel supported, turning a possible argument into a chance to learn together.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

Finding Outs from the Case Study:

Researching UPI fraud really opened my eyes to the fact that hackers don't usually "break into" our phones—they trick us into letting them in. The most shocking thing I found was how the "collect request" scam works. It's scary how easily someone can think they're *receiving* money when they're actually *giving it away* just by tapping a button. It's not about being "bad with tech"; it's about how these scams catch us when we're in a rush or distracted.

This research changed how I handle my own money. I’ve made a personal rule to always take a **"60-second pause"** before I approve any UPI request or click a payment link, especially if it feels urgent. That one minute of stopping to double-check might feel like a tiny delay, but it’s the best way to save myself from the massive stress and headache of a drained account.